# Core Hymns of Liturgical Life

The hymns, chants and canticles at the centre of liturgical life in the church orders, as listed so far, with the English title of each in the Hymn Index. The title is the **HYMN TITLE**, column A of `Hymn Index/LCMS-Worship-Lutheran-Hymn-Index.xlsx`, given exactly as the spreadsheet has it. For most hymns that is the title in LSB, TLH or ELH. For a hymn that none of the later hymnals prints, it is the first line in an older book: Walther's Hymnal (WH, Matthew Carver's English translation of KELG, numbered like it), ELHB (1912) or The Lutheran Hymnary (TLHy, 1913).

**Hymnals** gives the hymn's numbers in LSB, TLH and KELG where it has them, and otherwise in other hymnals, so that its row can be found; the abbreviations are those of `Hymn Index/README.md`. A dash means that the index has no row for the text; its literal English is given instead. The notes after the tables explain the entries marked with a number. The book treats these hymns in Chapter 8.

## Troped and paraphrased ordinaries

| Place | Hymn | Common English title (column A) | Hymnals |
|---|---|---|---|
| Kyrie | *Kyrie fons bonitatis* (the *Kyrie summum*) [1] | Lord God, our Father, Thou our chiefest stay | TLHy 43 |
| | "Kyrie, Gott Vater in Ewigkeit" [1] | Kyrie! God, Father in Heaven Above | LSB 942; TLH 6; KELG 7 |
| | "Ach Vater, allerhöchster Gott" | — (literally *Ah Father, highest God*) | |
| | "O Herre Gott" | — (literally *O Lord God*) | |
| | "O Vater allmächtiger Gott" | — (literally *O Father, almighty God*) | |
| Gloria | "Allein Gott in der Höh sei Ehr" | All Glory Be to God on High | LSB 947; TLH 237; KELG 1 |
| | "All Ehr und Lob soll Gottes sein" | All Glory Be to God Alone | LSB 948; TLH 238; KELG 142 |
| Creed | "Wir glauben all an einen Gott" [2] | We All Believe in One True God Maker | LSB 954; TLH 251; KELG 183 |
| Sanctus | "Jesaia dem Propheten das geschah" | Isaiah, Mighty Seer in Days of Old | LSB 960; TLH 249; KELG 147 |
| | "Heilig ist Gott der Vater" | — (literally *Holy is God the Father*) | |
| Lord's Prayer | "Vater unser im Himmelreich" | Our Father, Who From Heaven Above | LSB 766; TLH 458; KELG 185 |

| Place | Hymn | Common English title (column A) | Hymnals |
|---|---|---|---|
| Agnus Dei | "O Lamm Gottes unschuldig" | Lamb of God, Pure and Holy | LSB 434; TLH 146; KELG 86, 87 |

## Hymns during the service

| Place | Hymn | Common English title (column A) | Hymnals |
|---|---|---|---|
| Opening | TLH 224: "Komm, Heiliger Geist, Herre Gott" | Come, Holy Ghost, God and Lord | LSB 497; TLH 224; KELG 134 |
| | TLH 227: *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (the sequence) [3] | Come Holy Ghost in Love | TLH 227; ELH 11; TLHy 382 |
| | TLH 233: *Veni Creator Spiritus* | Come, Holy Ghost, Creator Blest | LSB 498, 499; TLH 233; ELH 10 |
| In place of the introit | "Es woll uns Gott genädig sein" (Ps 67) | May God Bestow on Us His Grace | LSB 823, 824; TLH 500; KELG 171 |
| | "Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott" (Ps 51) [4] | — (literally *Have mercy on me, O Lord God*) | |
| | "Aus tiefer Not schrei ich zu dir" (Ps 130) | From Depths of Woe I Cry to Thee | LSB 607; TLH 329; KELG 214 |
| | "Ach Gott, vom Himmel sieh darein" (Ps 12) | O Lord Look Down from Heaven Behold | TLH 260; KELG 166; ELH 440 |
| | "Wär Gott nicht mit uns diese Zeit" (Ps 124) [5] | If God Had Not Been on Our Side | TLH 267; KELG 162; ELH 396 |
| Chief hymn | from the table (to be decided) | — | |
| Before the sermon | "Nun bitten wir den Heiligen Geist" | To God the Holy Spirit Let Us Pray | LSB 768; TLH 231; KELG 136 |
| After the sermon | "Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort" | Lord, Keep Us Steadfast in Your Word | LSB 655; TLH 261; KELG 159 |
| | "Es woll uns Gott genädig sein" | May God Bestow on Us His Grace | LSB 823, 824; TLH 500; KELG 171 |
| | "Gott der Vater wohn uns bei" | Triune God, Be Thou Our Stay | LSB 505; TLH 247; KELG 145 |
| Distribution | "O Lamm Gottes unschuldig" | Lamb of God, Pure and Holy | LSB 434; TLH 146; KELG 86, 87 |

| Place | Hymn | Common English title (column A) | Hymnals |
|---|---|---|---|
| | "Jesus Christus, unser Heiland, der von uns den Gotteszorn wandt" | Jesus Christ, Our Blessed Savior | LSB 627; TLH 311; KELG 205 |
| | "Gott sei gelobet und gebenedeiet" | O Lord, We Praise Thee | LSB 617; TLH 313; KELG 195 |
| | Psalm 111 | — (a psalm) | |
| | *Te Deum laudamus* [6] | Te Deum laudamus | LSB p. 223; KELG 337; WS'69 745 |
| Closing | "Verleih uns Frieden gnädiglich" | Grant Peace, We Pray, in Mercy, Lord | LSB 777, 778; KELG 177; ELH 584 |
| | *Da pacem, Domine* [7] | — (literally *Give peace, O Lord*) | |
| | "Erhalt uns, Herr, bei deinem Wort" | Lord, Keep Us Steadfast in Your Word | LSB 655; TLH 261; KELG 159 |
| | "Es woll uns Gott genädig sein" | May God Bestow on Us His Grace | LSB 823, 824; TLH 500; KELG 171 |
| | "Sei Lob und Ehr mit hohem Preis" (the last stanza of "Es ist das Heil uns kommen her") [8] | Salvation Unto Us Has Come | LSB 555; TLH 377; KELG 237 |
| | "Danksagen wir alle Gott" [4] | — (literally *Let us all give thanks to God*) | |
| | *Nunc dimittis* [6] | Lord, Now You Let Your Servant | TLH p. 29; ELH p. 81, p. 124; CW'21 951 |
| After Mass | *Benedicite, omnia opera* [6] | All You Works of God, Bless the Lord | LSB 930; CW'21 958; HS'98 914 |
| | Psalm 150 | — (a psalm) | |

## Festal

| Place | Hymn | Common English title (column A) | Hymnals |
|---|---|---|---|
| Advent | "Nun komm, der Heiden Heiland" | Savior of the Nations, Come | LSB 332; TLH 95; KELG 36 |
| | *Veni, Domine, visitare nos in pace* | — (literally *Come, O Lord, visit us in peace*) | |

| Place | Hymn | Common English title (column A) | Hymnals |
|---|---|---|---|
| Christmas | *Grates nunc omnes reddamus* [7] | — (literally *Let us all now give thanks*) | |
| | "Gelobet seist du, Jesu Christ" | We Praise You, Jesus, at Your Birth | LSB 382; TLH 80; KELG 21 |
| | *Puer natus in Bethlehem* | A Boy Is Born in Bethlehem | ELH 112; TLHy 194; CW'21 348, 371 |
| | *In dulci jubilo* | Now Sing We, Now Rejoice | LSB 386; TLH 92; KELG 37 |
| | *Resonet in laudibus* [9] | — (literally *Let it resound with praises*) | |
| | *Nunc angelorum gloria* [9] | He Whom Shepherds Once Came Praising | LW 54; WS'69 718a, 718b, 718c; LBW 68 |
| | *Dies est laetitiae* [7] | — (literally *This is the day of gladness*) | |
| | "Joseph, lieber Joseph mein" | — (literally *Joseph, dear Joseph mine*) | |
| Lent | "Christe, der du bist Tag und Licht" [1] | Christ, everlasting Source of light | KELG 313; ELHB 34 |
| Easter | *Victimae paschali laudes* | Christians, to the Paschal Victim | LSB 460; LW 10; WS'69 741a |
| | "Christ lag in Todesbanden" | Christ Jesus lay in Death's Strong Bands | LSB 458; TLH 195; KELG 99 |
| | "Christ ist erstanden" | Christ is Arisen | LSB 459; TLH 187; KELG 98 |
| | "Also heilig ist der Tag" | This is such a holy day | KELG 96 |
| | *Surrexit Christus hodie* | Jesus Christ is Risen Today | LSB 457; TLH 199; ELH 352 |
| Ascension | "Christ fuhr gen Himmel" | Christ rose to heaven | KELG 119 |
| Pentecost | *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (the sequence), with "Nun bitten wir" [3] | Come Holy Ghost in Love | TLH 227; ELH 11; TLHy 382 |
| | *Spiritus Sancti gratia* | — (literally *The grace of the Holy Spirit*) | |
| | *Veni maxime Spiritus* | — (literally *Come, greatest Spirit*) | |

## Office hymns

| Place | Hymn | Common English title (column A) | Hymnals |
|---|---|---|---|
| Matins | Psalm 95 (*Venite*) [6] | O come let us sing | ELHB 575 |
| Lauds | *Benedictus Dominus Deus Israel* [6] | Blessed be the Lord God | ELHB 570 |
| Opening of the office | *Adesto, Deus unus* | — (literally *Be present, one God*) | |
| Vespers | *Salve Jesu Christe* | — (literally *Hail, Jesus Christ*) | |
| | *Da pacem, Domine* [7] | — (literally *Give peace, O Lord*) | |
| | *Salve Regina coeli*, turned upon Christ | — (literally *Hail, Queen of heaven*) | |
| | *Magnificat* [6] | My Soul Now Magnifies the Lord | LSB 934; TLH 275; ELH 47 |
| Compline | "Mitten wir im Leben sind" | In the Very Midst of Life | LSB 755; TLH 590; KELG 416 |
| | *Nunc dimittis* [6] | Lord, Now You Let Your Servant | TLH p. 29; ELH p. 81, p. 124; CW'21 951 |

## Catechism hymns

| Place | Hymn | Common English title (column A) | Hymnals |
|---|---|---|---|
| Ten Commandments | "Dies sind die heilgen zehn Gebot" | These Are the Holy Ten Commands | LSB 581; TLH 287; KELG 180 |
| | "Mensch, willst du leben seliglich" | Wilt thou, O man, live happily | KELG 181; ELHB 392; TL 274 |
| Creed | "Wir glauben all an einen Gott" [2] | We All Believe in One True God Maker | LSB 954; TLH 251; KELG 183 |
| | "Ich glaub an Gott" [10] | — (literally *I believe in God*) | |
| Lord's Prayer | "Vater unser im Himmelreich" | Our Father, Who From Heaven Above | LSB 766; TLH 458; KELG 185 |
| Baptism | "Christ, unser Herr, zum Jordan kam" | To Jordan Came the Christ, Our Lord | LSB 406, 407; KELG 186; ELH 247 |

| Place | Hymn | Common English title (column A) | Hymnals |
|---|---|---|---|
| Lord's Supper | "Jesus Christus, unser Heiland" | Jesus Christ, Our Blessed Savior | LSB 627; TLH 311; KELG 205 |
| | "Gott sei gelobet und gebenedeiet" | O Lord, We Praise Thee | LSB 617; TLH 313; KELG 195 |
| Keys and confession | "Aus tiefer Not schrei ich zu dir" | From Depths of Woe I Cry to Thee | LSB 607; TLH 329; KELG 214 |
| | "Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott" [4] | — (literally *Have mercy on me, O Lord God*) | |
| | "So wahr ich leb, spricht Gott der Herr" [11] | "As Surely as I Live," God Said | LSB 614; TLH 331; KELG 192 |

## For occasions

| Place | Hymn | Common English title (column A) | Hymnals |
|---|---|---|---|
| Baptism | "Christ, unser Herr, zum Jordan kam" | To Jordan Came the Christ, Our Lord | LSB 406, 407; KELG 186; ELH 247 |
| | "Vater unser im Himmelreich" | Our Father, Who From Heaven Above | LSB 766; TLH 458; KELG 185 |
| | stanzas of "Durch Adams Fall ist ganz verderbt" | All Mankind Fell in Adam's Fall | LSB 562; TLH 369; KELG 236 |
| | "Herr, schaff uns wie die kleinen Kind" | Lord, make us all as children small | KELG 189 |
| Wedding | Ps 128: "Wohl dem, der in Gottes Furcht steht" | Happy the man who feareth God | KELG 328; ELHB 446; TL 277 |
| | Ps 127: "Wo Gott zum Haus nicht gibt sein Gunst" [4] | — (literally *Where God gives not his favour to the house*) | |
| | "Nun bitten wir den Heiligen Geist" | To God the Holy Spirit Let Us Pray | LSB 768; TLH 231; KELG 136 |
| | *Te Deum laudamus* [6] | Te Deum laudamus | LSB p. 223; KELG 337; WS'69 745 |

| Place | Hymn | Common English title (column A) | Hymnals |
|---|---|---|---|
| | "Dein Eh sollst du bewahren rein" (the sixth commandment: stanza 7 of "Dies sind die heilgen zehn Gebot") | These Are the Holy Ten Commands | LSB 581; TLH 287; KELG 180 |
| The sick and dying | "Aus tiefer Not schrei ich zu dir" | From Depths of Woe I Cry to Thee | LSB 607; TLH 329; KELG 214 |
| | "Mit Fried und Freud ich fahr dahin" | In Peace and Joy I Now Depart | LSB 938; TLH 137; KELG 65 |
| | "Nun freut euch, lieben Christen gmein" | Dear Christians, One and All, Rejoice | LSB 556; TLH 387; KELG 243 |
| | the baptism and communion hymns (above) | see Baptism and Lord's Supper under the catechism hymns | |
| Burial | "Mitten wir im Leben sind" | In the Very Midst of Life | LSB 755; TLH 590; KELG 416 |
| | *Media vita in morte sumus* [7] | — (literally *In the midst of life we are in death*) | |
| | "Mit Fried und Freud ich fahr dahin" | In Peace and Joy I Now Depart | LSB 938; TLH 137; KELG 65 |
| | "Aus tiefer Not schrei ich zu dir" | From Depths of Woe I Cry to Thee | LSB 607; TLH 329; KELG 214 |
| | "Nun lasst uns den Leib begraben" | This Body in the Grave We Lay | LSB 759; TLH 596; KELG 417 |
| | "Wir glauben all an einen Gott" [2] | We All Believe in One True God Maker | LSB 954; TLH 251; KELG 183 |
| | *Si bona suscepimus* (responsory, Job 2:10) | — (literally *If we have received good at the hand of God*) | |
| | *Iam maesta quiesce querela* ("Jam moesta quiesce") [1] | Despair not, O heart in thy sorrow | TLHy 595 |
| Ordination and installation | "Nun bitten wir den Heiligen Geist" | To God the Holy Spirit Let Us Pray | LSB 768; TLH 231; KELG 136 |
| | "Komm, Heiliger Geist, Herre Gott" | Come, Holy Ghost, God and Lord | LSB 497; TLH 224; KELG 134 |
| | "Wir glauben all an einen Gott" [2] | We All Believe in One True God Maker | LSB 954; TLH 251; KELG 183 |

| Place | Hymn | Common English title (column A) | Hymnals |
|---|---|---|---|
| | *Te Deum laudamus* [6] | Te Deum laudamus | LSB p. 223; KELG 337; WS'69 745 |
| | "Danksagen wir alle Gott" [4] | — (literally *Let us all give thanks to God*) | |
| | *Veni Creator Spiritus* [1] | Come, Holy Ghost, Creator Blest | LSB 498, 499; TLH 233; ELH 10 |
| | *Veni Sancte Spiritus* (the antiphon) [3] | — (literally *Come, Holy Spirit, fill the hearts of thy faithful*) | |
| Thanksgiving days | *Te Deum laudamus* [6] | Te Deum laudamus | LSB p. 223; KELG 337; WS'69 745 |
| | Ps 124: "Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns hält" [5] | If God were not upon our side | KELG 438; ELHB 284 |
| | Ps 127: "Wo Gott zum Haus nicht gibt sein Gunst" [4] | — (literally *Where God gives not his favour to the house*) | |

## Notes

**1. Latin original and German version.** The index keeps some Latin hymns and their German versions on separate rows, each with its own title in column A.

- *Kyrie fons bonitatis* is "Lord God, our Father, Thou our chiefest stay" (TLHy 43). Its German version, "Kyrie, Gott Vater in Ewigkeit", is "Kyrie! God, Father in Heaven Above" (LSB 942, where it is titled "Kyrie! God, Father"; TLH 6).
- "Christe, der du bist Tag und Licht" is the German version of *Christe, qui lux es et dies*. Its row takes its title from WH and ELHB: "Christ, everlasting Source of light" (KELG 313, ELHB 34). The Latin hymn has the better-known "O Christ, Who Art the Light and Day" (LSB 882, TLH 559).
- *Iam maesta quiesce querela* (Prudentius) is "Despair not, O heart in thy sorrow" (TLHy 595). Its German version, "Hört auf mit Trauern und Klagen", is "Now Hush Your Cries and Shed No Tear" (KELG 408, ELH 480).
- *Veni Creator Spiritus* is "Come, Holy Ghost, Creator Blest". Luther's German version, "Komm, Gott Schöpfer, Heiliger Geist", is "Come, God, Creator, Holy Ghost" (KELG 132, ELHB 249).

The index records TLHy 43 and TLHy 595 as probable, not confirmed, translations of their Latin originals.

**2. Luther's creed hymn.** Two hymns open "We All Believe in One True God": Luther's (LSB 954, TLH 251) and Clausnitzer's (LSB 953, TLH 252). Column A tells them apart by a word added to the title, "Maker" for Luther's

and "Father" for Clausnitzer's. The hymnals print both as "We All Believe in One True God". The church orders mean Luther's.

**3. *Veni Sancte Spiritus*.** The name covers two texts. At Pentecost it is the sequence *Veni, Sancte Spiritus, et emitte caelitus*, with a stanza of "Nun bitten wir" after every two verses (§8.8.3); TLH 227, "Come Holy Ghost in Love", is that sequence. At the opening of the service and at ordination (§13.10.2) it is the antiphon *Veni, Sancte Spiritus, reple tuorum corda fidelium*, sung with a versicle and a collect. The index has no row for the Latin antiphon. Luther's German hymn on it, "Komm, Heiliger Geist, Herre Gott", is "Come, Holy Ghost, God and Lord" (LSB 497, TLH 224).

**4. Titles in `hymns.db` for hymns the index lacks.** None of the hymnals in the index has "Erbarm dich mein, o Herre Gott", "Danksagen wir alle Gott" or "Wo Gott zum Haus nicht gibt sein Gunst". The book's own hymn database, `hymns.db`, gives them English titles: "Have Mercy on Me, O Lord God", "We All Give Thanks to God" and "Unless the Lord Builds Up the House". No hymnal here has those titles, so the table gives the literal English instead.

**5. Two hymns on Psalm 124.** Luther's "Wär Gott nicht mit uns diese Zeit" is "If God Had Not Been on Our Side" (TLH 267). Justus Jonas's "Wo Gott der Herr nicht bei uns hält" is "If God were not upon our side" (KELG 438, ELHB 284). The titles are close, but the hymns are different.

**6. Canticles.** The index lists a canticle wherever a hymnal prints it, so some canticles have more than one row. The table gives the following rows:

- *Te Deum*: "Te Deum laudamus", the row of LSB's Matins *Te Deum* (p. 223) and of Luther's German *Te Deum*, "Herr Gott, dich loben wir" (KELG 337).
- *Nunc dimittis*: "Lord, Now You Let Your Servant", the canticle of TLH's communion service (p. 29) and of ELH. Luther's hymn on it, "Mit Fried und Freud ich fahr dahin", is "In Peace and Joy I Now Depart" (LSB 938, TLH 137).
- *Magnificat*: "My Soul Now Magnifies the Lord" (LSB 934, TLH 275). The index also has "My soul doth magnify the Lord" (ELHB 572) and "Magnificat" (HS'98 803).
- *Benedicite*: "All You Works of God, Bless the Lord" (LSB 930). The index also has "All You Works of the Lord" (LSB 931, LW 9).
- *Venite* (Psalm 95): only ELHB 575, "O come let us sing".
- *Benedictus*: "Blessed be the Lord God" (ELHB 570). The index also has "Blessed Be the God of Israel" (CW'21 954) and "Blest Be the God of Israel" (KELG 152, CW'93 275).

**7. Latin chants known through a German version.** The index has no row for these Latin texts, but it has the German versions of three of them:

- *Da pacem, Domine*: Luther's "Verleih uns Frieden gnädiglich", "Grant Peace, We Pray, in Mercy, Lord" (LSB 777, 778).
- *Media vita in morte sumus*: Luther's "Mitten wir im Leben sind", "In the Very Midst of Life" (LSB 755, TLH 590).
- *Dies est laetitiae*: "Der Tag, der ist so freudenreich", "Now Hail the Day So Rich in Cheer" (TLH 78, KELG 17).

The German version of *Grates nunc omnes reddamus*, "Danksagen wir alle Gott", is not in the index either.

**8. "Sei Lob und Ehr".** The church orders' closing hymn "Sei Lob und Ehr" is "Sei Lob und Ehr mit hohem Preis", the last stanza of Speratus's "Es ist das Heil uns kommen her" (§8.15.3), so the table gives that hymn's

title, "Salvation Unto Us Has Come". The English "Praise and honour be to the highest good" belongs to a later hymn, Johann Jakob Schütz's "Sei Lob und Ehr dem höchsten Gut" (1675), which is "Sing Praise to God, the Highest Good" (LSB 819, TLH 19).

**9. The Quempas.** The index files the three parts of the Quempas Celebration in WS'69 (718a–c) on one row, "He Whom Shepherds Once Came Praising" (LW 54). *Nunc angelorum gloria* is the second part, 718b, whose own first line is "The glorious angels came today". *Resonet in laudibus* is in the index only as the name of the tune of the third part, 718c ("God's own Son is born a child"). The Latin text has no row, and neither has "Joseph, lieber Joseph mein", which is sung to the same melody.

**10. "Ich glaub an Gott".** In the church orders this is the Apostles' Creed sung word for word in German prose, "Ich glaub an Gott Vater" (§8.9). It is not a hymn, and no hymnal prints it as one. `hymns.db` calls it "I Believe in God (Credo)".

**11. "So wahr ich leb".** The hymn of the keys is Nikolaus Herman's "So wahr ich leb, spricht Gott der Herr" (1560), which is *"As Surely as I Live," God Said* (LSB 614, TLH 331). Johann Heermann's "So wahr ich lebe, spricht dein Gott" (KELG 229) is a later and different hymn.